FIRST-TIME HOME BUYER'S ULTIMATE GUIDE (2026)

Prepared by: **Nirav Shah** | *Elevating Your Real Estate Experience*

STRATEGIC FINANCIAL INCENTIVES

Maximizing government programs can save you thousands in upfront costs:

- Provincial Land Transfer Tax Refund:
  Eligible first-time buyers can receive a refund of up to $4,000.
- RRSP Home Buyers' Plan (HBP):
  Withdraw up to $60,000 tax-free from your RRSP (repayable over 15 years).
- First Home Savings Account (FHSA):
  Save up to $8,000/year (tax-free in, tax-free out) specifically for your down payment.
- 2026 HST New Housing Rebate:
  Enhanced relief for new builds—eligible homes under $1M can access combined rebates of up to $130,000.

HOME TYPE COMPARISON MATRIX

Home Type	Pros	Cons
Detached	Maximum privacy, no shared walls, full control over property.	Highest price point; 100% responsible for all maintenance.
Semi-Detached	More affordable than detached; only one shared wall.	Shared wall noise potential; responsible for exterior maintenance.
Townhouse	Great entry-level price; lower maintenance; community feel.	Two shared walls; less privacy; may have monthly POTL fees.
Condominium	Lowest purchase price; building amenities.	Monthly condo fees; strict bylaws; no control over exterior.

NEW CONSTRUCTION VS. RESALE

- New Construction:
  Modern design, Tarion Warranty, and lower immediate maintenance.
  Note: Watch for interim occupancy fees and development charges.
- Resale Homes:
  Generally lower purchase prices and established neighborhoods.
  Note: Budget for immediate maintenance (roof/HVAC) and higher energy costs.

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- ## ESSENTIAL CHECKLISTS

Your Professional "Power Team"

- ➢ Realtor
- ➢ Mortgage Broker
- ➢ Real Estate Lawyer
- ➢ Home Inspector

Mortgage Approval Document Checklist

- ➢ ☐ Valid Photo ID (Driver's License or Passport)
- ➢ ☐ Employment Verification: Last 2–3 pay stubs and Letter of Employment
- ➢ ☐ Tax Records: T4s and Notice of Assessment (NOA) for last 2 years
- ➢ ☐ Proof of Down Payment: Bank statements for last 90 days

- ## ESTIMATING CLOSING COSTS

Budget 1.5% to 4% of the purchase price.

Example for a $500,000 home:

- ➢ Legal Fees: $1,500 – $2,500
- ➢ Home Inspection: $500 – $700
- ➢ Title Insurance: $500 – $1,000

READY TO FIND YOUR NEW HOME?

Navigating the Ontario market requires more than just a search—it requires a strategy. As your dedicated Realtor, I [1]provide personalized guidance and sharp negotiation to ensure you get the best deal possible.

Let's turn your vision into reality. Contact me today!

Nirav Shah

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Expertise in the GTA and Kitchener-Waterloo-Cambridge Regions

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[1]Legal Disclaimer

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